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Willow the Bunny Lovey

A bunny comforter: a soft, firmly stuffed head above a light, drapey granny-square blanket. Long floppy ears to hold, an embroidered face with no small parts, and a blanket that grows evenly from the centre out.

No small parts

Advanced beginner

2 - 3 hours

FINISHED SIZE

- Blanket about 26 cm (10 in) square (20 rounds).
- Head about 4.9 cm across; roughly 33 cm from ear tips to the opposite corner.
- DK cotton on a 3.5 mm hook (3.0 mm for the head if your tension is loose).

Design Code NS 10 · Pattern 10 of 10

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PATTERN OVERVIEW

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- Blanket about 26 cm (10 in) square (20 rounds).
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- DK cotton on a 3.5 mm hook (3.0 mm for the head if your tension is loose).

Sizing the blanket: the square grows ~1.3 cm per side per round - 18 rounds ~23 cm, 20 rounds ~26 cm, 22 rounds ~28 cm. Add rounds to make a bigger lovey.

No small parts · Advanced beginner · 2 - 3 hours

SAFETY FIRST

No safety eyes, buttons, beads or removable parts; the face is embroidered and every floss end is knotted inside the head. That is safer, but it is not a tested toy - do not describe Willow as "baby-safe" without ASTM F963 / EN 71 testing.

Comforters are not recommended in the cot for babies under 12 months and should be used with supervision; put that in your listing. Sew every seam twice and weave ends in at least 5 cm. Say "embroidered face, no small parts" - a claim you can stand behind.

MATERIALS

- Yarn: DK (#3) 100% cotton (or a baby-safe certified blend), about 60 g - cream, sage, dusty pink or pale grey. Only the head is stuffed.
- Hook: 3.5 mm (US E/4) for the blanket; use 3.0 mm for the head if your tension is loose.
- Eyes / floss: none - the face is embroidered in dark brown or charcoal cotton floss, ends knotted inside.
- Also: about 8 g fibre fill, tapestry needle, stitch marker.

GAUGE

Gauge: about 4.3 mm per stitch and 3.8 mm per round. Check on the blanket after Rnd 3: 9 dc along an edge should measure ~39 mm; narrower and the blanket comes out small.

ABBREVIATIONS

MR magic ring

ch chain

sc single crochet

dc double crochet

inc increase (2 sc in one st)

dec invisible decrease

sl st slip stitch

st(s) stitch(es)

sp space

FO fasten off

(n) stitch count at round end

CONSTRUCTION & TECHNIQUES

The HEAD and EARS are worked in a continuous spiral (no joins, marker in the first stitch). The BLANKET is worked in JOINED rounds: each round closes with a slip stitch and the next begins with a turning chain - a different rhythm that lets the square grow out evenly. Work every stitch through both loops unless noted.

1. Magic ring & spiral

The head and each ear begin with a magic ring; pull the tail tight after round one.

2. The granny-square corner

Every blanket corner is (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) into one corner space. Those four corners make the piece square instead of round. Miss one corner group and the whole square pulls out of true - check all four at the end of every round.

3. The border round

One final round of single crochet around the edge with 3 sc into each corner space squares the edge and stops the blanket curling. Do not skip it.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Head - worked top-down

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	ears at R4 - R6
R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	-
R6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	(36)	full width
R7	sc in each st around	(36)	-
R8	sc in each st around	(36)	face on R8 - R10
R9	sc in each st around	(36)	-
R10	[4 sc, dec] x 6	(30)	-
R11	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	stuff firmly
R12	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	-
R13	[sc, dec] x 6	(12)	top up stuffing
R14	dec x 6	(6)	close

FO and close with the tail. The finished head is about 4.9 cm across and 5.3 cm tall. Stuff it FIRMLY - a soft head collapses when gripped and the face distorts.

2. Ears - long and floppy (make 2, do not stuff)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	[sc, inc] x 3	(9)	-

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R3	[2 sc, inc] x 3	(12)	-
R4-8	sc in each st around (5 rnd)	(12)	-
R9	[2 sc, dec] x 3	(9)	-
R10	sc in each st around	(9)	-
R11	[sc, dec] x 3	(6)	flatten, FO

Flatten and FO with a long tail. Sew to Rnds 4-6 of the head, about 10 stitches apart, pinching each base so it flops forward.

3. Blanket - granny square, joined rounds

Ch 4 and sl st to the first ch to form a ring. Every round closes with a slip stitch into the top of the starting ch-3.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
Rnd 1	ch 3 (counts as first dc), 2 dc in the ring, [ch 2, 3 dc in the ring] x 3, ch 2, sl st to the ch-3 top	(12)	12 dc, 4 corner spaces
Rnd 2	sl st into the next corner space; ch 3, 2 dc in that space, ch 2, 3 dc in the same space (first corner); then (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) into each remaining corner space; sl st to close	(24)	+12 dc
Rnds 3-20	into every corner space work (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc), and into every space along a side work 3 dc; sl st to close. Each round adds one 3-dc group to every side (+12 dc per round)	-	see dc table

Total dc per round: Rnd 3 = 36, Rnd 5 = 60, Rnd 10 = 120, Rnd 15 = 180, Rnd 20 = 240 (60 dc per edge = ~26 cm).

Border: work one final round of sc all the way around - 1 sc into each dc and 3 sc into each corner space - then sl st and FO. At Rnd 20 that is 240 sc + 12 corner sc = 252 sc. This firms the edge and stops the square curling.

Open dc clusters and crisp (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) corners keep the square true round after round.

FINISHING & ASSEMBLY

- Face (embroidery only): two small oval eyes about 8 stitches apart across Rnds 8-9, a small inverted-triangle nose centred between and below them, and a shallow Y for the mouth. KNOT every end inside the head and bury the tails before closing. Skip blush - chalk rubs off on bedding and is not washable.
- Joining: centre the head over one corner of the square, overlapping the blanket by about 3 cm. Sew all the way around the base of the head, THEN sew it a second time - this is the only structural seam and it will be pulled, chewed and washed. Weave every end in at least 5 cm.

TROUBLESHOOTING

- **Blanket curls / not square.**

You skipped the sc border, or missed a (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) corner - check all four corners at the end of every round.

- **Came out too small / head flops.**

Tighter than 4.3 mm/dc: go up a hook or add rounds (22 rounds = ~28 cm). Stuff the head firmly and sew the base seam twice.

COLORWAYS

Cream

Sage

Dusty pink

Pale grey

Butter yellow

HELPFUL TIPS

For your listing

Materials: 100% cotton, embroidered face, no safety eyes, no buttons, beads or removable parts.

Care: machine wash cool on a gentle cycle inside a mesh bag; reshape while damp and dry flat. Do not tumble dry - it will felt and shrink.

Supervision: comforters are not recommended in the cot for babies under 12 months; use with supervision.

- Colorways: cream, sage, dusty pink, pale grey and butter yellow - neutrals outsell brights in the baby category.

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Safety reminder

Willow has NO safety eyes, buttons, beads or removable parts - the face is embroidered and floss ends are knotted inside the head. Even so she is not a tested toy (ASTM F963 / EN 71): do not claim “baby-safe”. Comforters are not recommended in a cot for babies under 12 months and should be used with supervision; sew every seam twice and weave ends in at least 5 cm.

Happy crocheting!

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